Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 19: Infrastructure: Engine of India's Development

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	19 — Infrastructure: Engine of India's Development
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: **+4** for each correct answer · **−1** for each wrong answer · **0** if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: infrastructure is NOT only roads and buildings - it includes social infrastructure (schools, hospitals, courts, parks) and invisible systems (power grids, water pipelines, networks); the British built the railways (1853) for their OWN benefit, not to help Indians; caring for public infrastructure is a COLLECTIVE duty, not only the government's; and the Indian scientist J.C. Bose contributed to radio-wave communication. Classify facilities correctly as physical vs social. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. 'Infrastructure' means:
(A) only the tallest buildings in a city (B) the money a country prints
(C) the basic facilities and systems a country needs to function
(D) the laws a parliament passes

2. The chapter calls infrastructure the ____ of India's development.
(A) enemy (B) smallest part
(C) engine (D) final result only

3. Infrastructure is divided into two main types:
(A) ancient and modern (B) cheap and expensive
(C) physical and social (D) visible and imaginary

4. The word 'infrastructure' comes from Latin roots meaning:
(A) 'below' and 'a building' - the structure that lies beneath everything else
(B) 'above' and 'the sky' (C) 'fast' and 'road'
(D) 'far' and 'to share'

5. The claim 'infrastructure means only roads and buildings' is wrong because it also includes:

(A) social facilities and invisible systems like power grids and water pipelines
(B) nothing beyond roads (C) only the army
(D) only money

6. 'Physical infrastructure' includes:
(A) schools, hospitals, courts and parks (B) only money and banks
(C) transport, utilities, communication and energy systems
(D) only laws and courts

7. 'Social infrastructure' includes:
(A) roads, ports, power grids and pipelines(B) only highways
(C) only airports (D) schools, hospitals, courts and parks

8. A new highway is an example of ____ infrastructure, while a new hospital is ____ infrastructure.
(A) social ... physical (B) physical ... physical
(C) social ... social (D) physical ... social

9. The claim 'schools and hospitals aren't really infrastructure - only roads and power are' is wrong because:
(A) schools and hospitals are physical infrastructure
(B) only roads count as infrastructure
(C) social infrastructure (schools, hospitals, sanitation) is one of the two arms of infrastructure
(D) nothing is infrastructure

10. Why does a country need both physical and social infrastructure?
(A) only roads matter for development (B) only schools matter for development
(C) healthy, educated people are as vital to development as good roads and power
(D) neither matters at all

11. Power grids, water pipelines and communication networks are infrastructure that is:
(A) not really infrastructure at all (B) largely invisible yet essential
(C) only social infrastructure (D) only found abroad

12. Infrastructure is called the 'backbone' of development because:
(A) it has nothing to do with the economy
(B) economic activity depends on transport, power, water and communication working
(C) it slows development down (D) it matters only to tourists

13. A region with poor roads, unreliable power and few schools is likely to:
(A) develop fastest of all (B) need no infrastructure
(C) struggle to develop economically and socially
(D) have the best hospitals automatically

14. India's road network is described as the:

(A) world's smallest
(B) only one highway long
(C) entirely unpaved
(D) world's second-largest

15. The 'Golden Quadrilateral' is a highway network connecting:

(A) only Delhi and Mumbai
(B) four foreign capitals
(C) four small villages
(D) Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Kolkata

16. 'NH44' is notable as:

(A) a metro line in one city
(B) a major national highway of India
(C) a sea port
(D) a solar park

17. An 'expressway' is:

(A) a slow village lane
(B) an underground metro line
(C) a sea route between ports
(D) a high-speed national road joining cities across states, built by the central government

18. The Golden Quadrilateral and NH44 are examples of ____ infrastructure.

(A) physical (transport)
(B) social
(C) imaginary
(D) foreign-only

19. Good highways help development mainly by:

(A) blocking all trade
(B) replacing the need for schools
(C) moving goods and people quickly between regions
(D) stopping people from travelling

20. The Indian Railways were first built in:

(A) 1947, at independence
(B) 1853, during colonial rule
(C) 1995, by J.C. Bose
(D) ancient times

21. The claim 'the British built railways in India to help Indians' is wrong because they built them mainly to:

(A) give Indians free travel
(B) help Indian farmers only
(C) export India's raw materials, sell British goods, and move troops to control India
(D) spread Indian culture abroad

22. Today the Indian Railways carry about:

(A) 20 people a day
(B) no passengers at all
(C) only freight, never people
(D) 20 million people a day

23. The railways are described as having turned from a colonial tool into:

(A) a national lifeline for India
(B) a useless ruin
(C) a purely British-owned company today(D) a metro system only

24. The railways' history shows that infrastructure built for one purpose can:

(A) never be used for anything else
(B) only ever harm a country
(C) vanish after a few years
(D) later serve a very different, wider purpose

25. The railways and roads together form part of India's _____ infrastructure.

(A) social
(B) transport (physical)
(C) communication-only
(D) energy-only

26. A 'metro' is:

(A) a fast urban rail system, often underground or elevated, that helps commuters avoid road traffic
(B) a national highway between states
(C) a sea port
(D) a power grid

27. Metros are especially useful in:

(A) busy cities, to move many commuters and reduce road congestion
(B) empty deserts with no people
(C) the open sea
(D) the upper atmosphere

28. 'Aviation', from the Latin for 'bird', is the activity of:

(A) sailing ships between ports
(B) flying aircraft and running air transport
(C) building roads
(D) laying water pipes

29. India is said to have about:

(A) only 1 airport
(B) no airports at all
(C) 159 sea ports and no airports
(D) 159 airports

30. Airports and aircraft are part of India's _____ infrastructure.

(A) transport (physical)
(B) social
(C) energy-only
(D) imaginary

31. A 'port' is:

(A) a town with a harbour where ships load and unload cargo
(B) a high-speed road
(C) an underground metro
(D) a power station

32. India's busy sea ports are found on:

(A) both its coasts
(B) only in the Himalayas
(C) only in deserts
(D) only abroad

33. 'TEU' (Twenty-foot Equivalent Unit) measures:

(A) the speed of a metro train
(B) the height of an airport
(C) container-ship and port capacity, in standard containers
(D) the length of a highway

34. A port handling more TEUs than another is handling:

(A) more standard shipping containers (B) fewer containers
(C) more aircraft (D) more trains

35. The claim 'modern communication technology like radio was invented entirely in the West' is wrong because:

(A) India never worked on radio at all (B) radio was invented in ancient times
(C) the British invented everything in 1853
(D) the Indian scientist J.C. Bose demonstrated radio-wave communication and improved the 'coherer' detector

36. J.C. Bose's pioneering wireless work dates to about:

(A) 1895 (B) 1853
(C) 1947 (D) ancient times

37. A 'coherer', improved by J.C. Bose, was a device that:

(A) carried passengers on rails (B) pumped water to homes
(C) generated solar power (D) decoded transmitted wireless signals

38. A 'patent' is:

(A) a tax on imported goods (B) a kind of highway
(C) a sea port
(D) a government-granted right to be the only one who can make, sell or use an invention for a number of years

39. J.C. Bose is noted for choosing:

(A) to patent every idea and grow rich (B) not to patent much of his work
(C) to keep all his work secret forever (D) to invent nothing at all

40. 'Telecommunication', from Greek and Latin roots, means:

(A) building roads between far cities
(B) sending information over long distances by phone, radio or internet
(C) flying aircraft long distances (D) shipping cargo by sea

41. 'Energy infrastructure' includes:

(A) dams, solar parks and wind farms (B) schools and hospitals
(C) courts and parks (D) ports and airports

42. A 'utility', from the Latin for 'useful', is:

(A) a basic public service like water, electricity or gas supplied to homes
(B) a high-speed expressway (C) a wireless coherer
(D) a shipping container

43. Energy and utilities matter to all other infrastructure because:

(A) they are unrelated to anything else (B) only homes use power
(C) power harms development
(D) transport, communication and social services all need power and water to run

44. Solar parks and wind farms are examples of energy infrastructure that is:
(A) powered only by burning coal (B) based on cleaner, renewable sources
(C) not really infrastructure (D) purely social infrastructure

45. Courts and parks, alongside schools and hospitals, are examples of:
(A) physical transport infrastructure (B) social infrastructure
(C) energy infrastructure (D) communication infrastructure

46. Good social infrastructure helps development by:
(A) only moving goods faster (B) replacing the need for roads
(C) harming people's wellbeing
(D) producing healthy, educated people who can contribute to society

47. Sanitation, listed under social infrastructure, mainly supports:
(A) people's health and wellbeing (B) faster aircraft
(C) bigger ports (D) longer highways

48. The claim 'only the government is responsible for public infrastructure' is wrong because:
(A) citizens may damage it freely (B) infrastructure needs no care
(C) caring for public infrastructure is a collective responsibility of citizens too
(D) only foreigners maintain it

49. Caring for public infrastructure as a citizen includes:
(A) using it well, not damaging it, and reporting problems
(B) breaking it whenever convenient (C) ignoring all damage
(D) leaving everything to foreign countries

50. A student who keeps a public park clean and reports a broken streetlight is showing:
(A) that infrastructure is only the government's job
(B) collective responsibility for shared infrastructure
(C) that infrastructure needs no care (D) foreign control of infrastructure

51. Treating infrastructure as a shared duty matters because:
(A) damaged infrastructure helps a country develop
(B) care makes no difference
(C) well-cared-for infrastructure lasts longer and serves everyone better
(D) only the rich benefit from it

52. 'Sustainable infrastructure' is built with:

(A) the most polluting materials available(B) no concern for the environment

(C) clean energy and eco-friendly materials to minimise pollution and harm to biodiversity

(D) only ancient tools

53. A 'living root bridge', a natural piece of infrastructure, is made by:

(A) pouring concrete over a river

(B) guiding tree roots to grow across a stream, as by the Khasi and Jaintia tribes of Meghalaya

(C) laying steel rails (D) building a metro tunnel

54. Living root bridges show that infrastructure can be:

(A) only made of concrete and steel (B) always harmful to nature

(C) sustainable and in harmony with nature(D) impossible to build naturally

55. Building with clean energy and eco-friendly materials makes infrastructure more:

(A) polluting and wasteful (B) expensive with no benefit

(C) useless to people (D) sustainable, harming the environment less

56. The idea of caring for infrastructure has ancient roots in:

(A) a 1995 wireless experiment (B) Kautilya's Arthashastra

(C) the Golden Quadrilateral (D) the Constitution of 1950

57. That the Arthashastra discussed infrastructure shows that:

(A) infrastructure was unknown before modern times

(B) only the British thought about it

(C) caring for roads and public works is an ancient Indian concern, not only a modern one

(D) infrastructure does not matter

58. Which pairing of facility and type is correct?

(A) a power grid - social infrastructure; a hospital - physical infrastructure

(B) a power grid - physical infrastructure; a hospital - social infrastructure

(C) both are social infrastructure (D) both are transport infrastructure

59. 'Logistics', important to infrastructure, is:

(A) the flying of aircraft

(B) the detailed organising of moving, storing and supplying goods

(C) the worship of a deity (D) a kind of tax

60. A student says, 'Infrastructure means only roads, the British built railways to help Indians, and only the government must care for it.' The best correction is:

(A) all three statements are correct

(B) infrastructure is only roads, but citizens must care for it

(C) the British built railways to help Indians, and citizens share the duty

(D) infrastructure includes social and invisible systems too, the British built railways for their own benefit, and caring for it is a collective duty

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 19: Infrastructure: Engine of India's Development

Marking: **+4** correct, **−1** wrong, **0** unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	B	21	C	31	A	41	A	51	C
2	C	12	B	22	D	32	A	42	A	52	C
3	C	13	C	23	A	33	C	43	D	53	B
4	A	14	D	24	D	34	A	44	B	54	C
5	A	15	D	25	B	35	D	45	B	55	D
6	C	16	B	26	A	36	A	46	D	56	B
7	D	17	D	27	A	37	D	47	A	57	C
8	D	18	A	28	B	38	D	48	C	58	B
9	C	19	C	29	D	39	B	49	A	59	B
10	C	20	B	30	A	40	B	50	B	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) Infrastructure is the basic facilities and systems a country needs (physical and social). It is not just tall buildings, money, or laws.

2. (C) Infrastructure is the engine of India's development. It is not its enemy, smallest part, or merely a final result.

3. (C) The two types are physical (transport, utilities, communication, energy) and social (schools, hospitals, courts, parks). The other pairings are not the chapter's types.

4. (A) Infrastructure is from infra ('below') + structura ('a building'). 'Far + to share' gives telecommunication; the others are invented.

5. (A) Infrastructure also covers social facilities (schools, hospitals) and invisible systems (power grids, water pipes, networks). It is not roads-only, the army, or money.

6. (C) Physical infrastructure is transport, utilities, communication and energy. Schools, hospitals, courts and parks are social infrastructure.

7. (D) Social infrastructure is schools, hospitals, courts and parks, supporting wellbeing. Roads, ports and grids are physical infrastructure.

8. (D) A highway is physical infrastructure; a hospital is social infrastructure. The other pairings misclassify them.

9. (C) Infrastructure has two arms: physical (roads, power) and social (schools, hospitals, sanitation). Healthy, educated people matter as much as roads.

10. (C) Development needs both: physical infrastructure moves goods and power, while social infrastructure builds healthy, educated people. Neither alone is enough.

11. (B) Invisible systems like power grids, water pipes and networks are essential physical infrastructure. They are infrastructure, are physical not social, and are found in India.

12. (B) A working economy depends on transport, power, water and communication, so infrastructure is the backbone of development. It is not economy-irrelevant, a brake, or tourist-only.

13. (C) Weak physical and social infrastructure hampers development. It does not speed growth, remove the need for infrastructure, or guarantee good hospitals.

14. (D) India has the world's second-largest road network. It is not the smallest, a single highway, or entirely unpaved.

15. (D) The Golden Quadrilateral links Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Kolkata. It is not just two cities, foreign capitals, or villages.

16. (B) NH44 is a major (the longest) national highway of India. It is not a metro line, a port, or a solar park.

17. (D) An expressway is a high-speed national road across states, built by the central government. It is not a village lane, a metro, or a sea route.

18. (A) Highways are physical (transport) infrastructure. They are not social, imaginary, or foreign-only.

19. (C) Highways speed the movement of goods and people, aiding development. They do not block trade, replace schools, or stop travel.

20. (B) The railways began in 1853 under colonial rule. They were not built in 1947, by J.C. Bose, or in ancient times.

21. (C) The British built the 1853 railways for their own benefit - exporting raw materials, selling British goods and moving troops. The railways only later became India's lifeline.

22. (D) The railways carry about 20 million people a day, a national lifeline. They carry far more than 20 people, do carry passengers, and move both people and freight.

23. (A) The colonial-era railways became India's national lifeline. They are not a ruin, British-owned today, or merely a metro.

24. (D) Railways built for colonial gain later became India's lifeline, showing infrastructure can serve new purposes. It is not single-use, only harmful, or short-lived.

25. (B) Railways and roads are transport, a physical infrastructure. They are not social, communication, or energy infrastructure.

26. (A) A metro is a fast urban rail system (often underground or elevated) easing city traffic. It is not a highway, a port, or a power grid.

27. (A) Metros serve busy cities, moving commuters and easing congestion. They are not for empty deserts, the sea, or the sky.

28. (B) Aviation (Latin avis, 'bird') is flying aircraft and running air transport. Ships are shipping, roads are road transport, and pipes are utilities.

29. (D) India has about 159 airports. It is not one, none, or 159 sea ports.

30. (A) Air transport is physical (transport) infrastructure. It is not social, energy, or imaginary.

31. (A) A port (Latin portus, 'harbour') is a harbour town where ships load and unload cargo. It is not a road, a metro, or a power station.

32. (A) India has busy sea ports on both coasts. They are not in the Himalayas, deserts, or only abroad.

33. (C) TEU measures container-ship and port capacity in standard containers. It is not metro speed, airport height, or highway length.

34. (A) More TEUs means more standard containers handled. It does not mean fewer containers, aircraft, or trains.

35. (D) J.C. Bose demonstrated radio-wave communication and improved the coherer before such work became famous abroad. India contributed to the science of communication.

36. (A) Bose's wireless work dates to about 1895. 1853 is the railways, 1947 independence, and ancient times far too early.

37. (D) The coherer was an early device, improved by Bose, that decoded wireless signals. It did not carry passengers, pump water, or generate solar power.

38. (D) A patent is a government right to be the sole maker, seller or user of an invention for some years. It is not a tax, a highway, or a port.

39. (B) Bose chose not to patent much of his work. He did not patent everything, hide it forever, or invent nothing.

40. (B) Telecommunication (Greek tele 'far' + Latin communicare 'to share') is sending information over long distances. It is not road-building, flying, or shipping.

41. (A) Energy infrastructure includes dams, solar parks and wind farms. Schools and hospitals and courts and parks are social, and ports and airports are transport.

42. (A) A utility (Latin utilis, 'useful') is a basic public service such as water, electricity or gas. It is not a road, a coherer, or a container.

43. (D) Power and water underpin transport, communication and social services, so energy and utilities support everything else. They are not unrelated, home-only, or harmful.

44. (B) Solar parks and wind farms use cleaner, renewable energy. They are not coal-only, non-infrastructure, or social infrastructure.

45. (B) Courts and parks are social infrastructure, supporting wellbeing. They are not transport, energy, or communication infrastructure.

46. (D) Social infrastructure builds healthy, educated people who drive development. It is not about moving goods, replacing roads, or harming wellbeing.

47. (A) Sanitation supports health and wellbeing, a social-infrastructure goal. It is not about aircraft, ports, or highways.

48. (C) While the government builds and maintains infrastructure, citizens share responsibility - using it well, not damaging it, and reporting problems. It is not free to damage, care-free, or foreigner-maintained.

49. (A) Citizens care for infrastructure by using it well, not damaging it, and reporting problems. Breaking it, ignoring damage and leaving it to foreigners are the opposite.

50. (B) Keeping a park clean and reporting faults is collective responsibility for shared infrastructure. It is not leaving it to government, care-free, or foreign control.

51. (C) Shared care keeps infrastructure lasting and serving everyone. Damage harms development, care does matter, and infrastructure benefits all, not only the rich.

52. (C) Sustainable infrastructure uses clean energy and eco-friendly materials to limit pollution and protect biodiversity. It is not pollution-heavy, environment-blind, or toollimited.

53. (B) A living root bridge is grown by guiding tree roots across a stream, by the Khasi and Jaintia tribes of Meghalaya - sustainable, natural infrastructure. It is not concrete, rails, or a tunnel.

54. (C) Living root bridges show sustainable, nature-friendly infrastructure. It need not be concrete-and-steel, is not always harmful, and can be natural.

55. (D) Clean energy and eco-friendly materials make infrastructure sustainable, with less environmental harm. It is not more polluting, benefit-free, or useless.

56. (B) Concern for infrastructure has ancient roots in Kautilya's Arthashastra. Bose's wireless work, the Golden Quadrilateral and the Constitution are far later.

57. (C) The Arthashastra shows infrastructure was an ancient Indian concern, not only modern. It was not unknown, British-only, or unimportant.

58. (B) A power grid is physical infrastructure; a hospital is social infrastructure. The other options misclassify them.

59. (B) Logistics (Greek logistike, 'skill in calculating') is organising the movement, storage and supply of goods. It is not flying, worship, or a tax.

60. (D) Infrastructure includes social and invisible systems, the 1853 railways served British interests, and its care is a collective duty - correcting all three errors. The other options keep one or more misconceptions.